

Word family: **album / albums**

Base word: album

Part of speech: mainly **noun**

Useful expressions / extensions:

* **photo album**

* **family album**

* **wedding album**

* **scrapbook album**

* **album cover**

* **album track**

* **studio album**

* **live album**

* **debut album**

* **concept album**

* **album release**

* **album collection**

* **digital album**

Meaning in this passage

> A gift that really stands out in my memory was a handmade photo **album** I gave to my mother.

Here, **album** means:

a book or collection used to keep and display photographs — 相簿；照片簿

中文翻譯：

我記憶中最深刻的一份禮物，就是我送給媽媽的一本手工**相簿**。

So here:

photo album = 用來整理、保存和展示照片的相簿

1. **photo album — 相簿；照片簿**

This is the meaning used in your passage.

Practice 1 — original sentence

> I gave my mother a handmade photo **album**.

我送給媽媽一本手工**相簿**。

Practice 2

> We looked through an old family **album**.

我們一起翻看一本舊的家庭**相簿**。

Practice 3

> She keeps her childhood photos in a large **album**.

她把童年照片放在一本大**相簿**裏。

MCQ-ready definition:

album = 用來保存、整理和展示照片的簿冊或收藏冊

2. **family album — 家庭相簿**

Practice 1

> The **family album** contains photos from several generations.

這本**家庭相簿**收錄了幾代人的照片。

Practice 2

> We found an old **family album** in the cupboard.

我們在櫃裏找到一本舊**家庭相簿**。

MCQ-ready definition:

family album = 主要保存家庭成員、聚會和家庭回憶照片的相簿

3. **wedding album — 婚禮相簿**

Practice 1

> They showed us their **wedding album**.

他們給我們看了他們的**婚禮相簿**。

Practice 2

> The photographer designed a beautiful **wedding album**.

攝影師設計了一本很漂亮的**婚禮相簿**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****wedding album = 專門收藏婚禮照片的相簿****

4. **scrapbook album — 剪貼簿式相簿**

This is especially relevant to your passage.

Practice 1

> She made a **scrapbook album** with photos and tickets.

她做了一本放有照片和票根的**剪貼簿式相簿**。

Practice 2

> The **album** included notes, receipts, and small decorations.

那本**相簿 / 剪貼簿**裏有紙條、收據和小裝飾。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****scrapbook album = 除照片外，還加入文字、票根、紙條、裝飾等紀念物的收藏簿****

5. **album (音樂專輯) — 音樂專輯；大碟**

A major separate modern sense.

Practice 1

> The singer released a new **album** last month.

那位歌手上個月推出了一張新**專輯**。

Practice 2

> This is my favourite **album** by the band.

這是最喜歡的該樂隊**大碟 / 專輯**。

MCQ-ready definition:

album = 由多首歌曲或音樂作品組成、作為一套正式發行的音樂作品

6. **studio album — 錄音室專輯**

Practice 1

> This is the band's third **studio album**.

這是樂隊的第三張**錄音室專輯**。

Practice 2

> The **studio album** took two years to complete.

這張**錄音室專輯**花了兩年完成。

MCQ-ready definition:

studio album = 主要在錄音室錄製、正式發行的音樂專輯

7. **live album — 現場錄音專輯**

Practice 1

> They released a **live album** from the concert tour.

他們推出了一張巡迴演唱會的**現場錄音專輯**。

Practice 2

> The **live album** captures the energy of the performance.

這張**現場專輯**保留了演出的現場氣氛。

MCQ-ready definition:

live album = 主要收錄現場演出錄音的音樂專輯

8. **debut album — 首張專輯**

Practice 1

> Her **debut album** became very successful.

她的**首張專輯**非常成功。

Practice 2

> The band recorded its **debut album** in London.

樂隊在倫敦錄製了**首張大碟**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****debut album = 歌手或樂隊正式推出的第一張專輯****

9. **concept album — 概念專輯**

Practice 1

> The band created a **concept album** about city life.

樂隊製作了一張以城市生活為主題的**概念專輯**。

Practice 2

> Every song on the **concept album** is connected to the same story.

這張**概念專輯**中的每首歌都和同一個故事有關。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****concept album = 多首歌曲圍繞同一主題、故事或概念設計的專輯****

10. **album track — 專輯歌曲**

Practice 1

> This song was originally just an **album track**.

這首歌原本只是一首**專輯歌曲**。

Practice 2

> Several **album tracks** later became popular.

有幾首**專輯收錄曲**後來變得很受歡迎。

MCQ-ready definition:

album track = 收錄在專輯中的其中一首歌曲

11. **album cover — 專輯封面**

Practice 1

> The **album cover** was designed by a famous artist.

這張**專輯封面**由一位著名藝術家設計。

Practice 2

> I recognized the record from its **album cover**.

我從**專輯封面**認出了這張唱片。

MCQ-ready definition:

album cover = 音樂專輯的封面設計或外包裝圖像

12. **album release — 專輯發行**

Practice 1

> The **album release** is scheduled for Friday.

專輯發行安排在星期五。

Practice 2

> Fans celebrated the new **album release**.

粉絲慶祝新**專輯推出**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****album release = 音樂專輯正式公開發售或上線的行為 / 時間****

13. ****album (收藏冊) — 收藏簿 ; 紀念冊****

Historically and in some current contexts, ****album**** can refer more broadly to a book for keeping collections.

Practice 1

> He keeps the stamps in an ****album****.

他把郵票收藏在一本****集郵冊****裏。

Practice 2

> She has an ****album**** full of old postcards.

她有一本放滿舊明信片的****收藏冊****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****album = 用來整理和保存照片、郵票、明信片等收藏品的簿冊****

14. ****stamp album — 集郵冊****

Practice 1

> His grandfather gave him a ****stamp album****.

他的祖父送了他一本****集郵冊****。

Practice 2

> The ****stamp album**** contains stamps from many countries.

這本****集郵冊****有來自很多國家的郵票。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****stamp album = 專門用來收藏和展示郵票的冊子****

15. **digital album — 數碼相簿 / 數碼專輯**

This expression can belong to either the photo or music branch, depending on context.

Practice 1

> She created a **digital photo album** for the family.

她為家人製作了一個**數碼相簿**。

Practice 2

> The **digital album** is available on streaming platforms.

這張**數碼專輯**可在串流平台收聽。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****digital album = 以數碼形式保存的一組照片，或以數碼形式發行的音樂專輯****

Important distinction 1: **album vs scrapbook**

This matters directly in your passage.

album

a book/collection for photos or other items.

scrapbook

a book where you actively combine:

- * photos
- * notes
- * tickets
- * receipts
- * decorations
- * clippings

So the speaker's gift can correctly be described as both:

> a handmade photo **album**

and:

> a **scrapbook**

But **scrapbook** emphasizes the creative mixed-material format more strongly.

Important distinction 2: **album** vs **photo album**

album

can mean:

- * photo album
- * music album
- * collection book

photo album

removes the ambiguity.

So:

> I bought an album.

could require context.

> I bought a photo album.

clearly means 相簿.

Important distinction 3: **album** vs **book**

book

broad object with pages, usually for reading.

album

organized collection, usually meant for viewing or preserving items rather than continuous reading.

A photo album is physically book-like, but its function differs.

Important distinction 4: **album vs collection**

collection

the group of items themselves.

album

the organized container/publication holding or presenting that collection.

> a collection of family photos

一批家庭照片

> a family photo album

家庭相簿

Important distinction 5: **album vs record**

In music:

album

collection of tracks released together.

record

can mean:

* recording generally

* physical vinyl record

* sometimes album informally

So:

> new album

is clearer when referring to the full collection of songs.

Important distinction 6: **album vs single**

album

multiple tracks.

single

one main song, sometimes with a few additional tracks.

> release an album

推出專輯

> release a single

推出單曲

Important distinction 7: **album vs EP**

album

usually a fuller-length release.

EP

shorter musical release, normally longer than a single but shorter than a full album.

Exact conventions vary by platform/industry, but the distinction is useful.

Important distinction 8: **album vs playlist**

album

released as a coherent official collection by an artist.

playlist

a user/editor-created list of tracks, potentially from many artists/albums.

A playlist is not automatically an album.

Important distinction 9: **album vs series**

album

one organized collection/publication.

series

multiple related works/items issued or appearing over time.

A photographer could publish a **series of albums**.

Important distinction 10: **photo album vs gallery**

photo album

an organized collection, physical or digital.

gallery

a place/interface where images are displayed.

On a phone, a gallery can contain many albums.

Important distinction 11: **album can be countable**

Unlike some collection nouns, **album** is normally countable:

> one album

> two albums

This applies to both:

* photo albums

* music albums

Family-extension note

Album has two especially strong modern branches:

1. **collection book**

- * photo album
- * family album
- * stamp album
- * scrapbook-style album

2. **music release**

- * studio album
- * live album
- * debut album
- * concept album

The historical conceptual connection is straightforward:

a collection of items gathered into one organized unit

Originally this could mean a book containing collections; modern music then extended the same idea to a collection of recordings released together.

So the two senses are distinct for learners, but they share a clear semantic core.

Master comparison

Form / expression	Traditional Chinese	Core idea
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photo album	相簿；照片簿	photo collection
family album	家庭相簿	family-photo collection
wedding album	婚禮相簿	wedding photos
scrapbook album	剪貼簿式相簿	mixed memory collection
album (collection book)	收藏冊	organized collection
stamp album	集郵冊	stamp collection
album (music)	音樂專輯；大碟	collection of tracks
studio album	錄音室專輯	studio-recorded release
live album	現場錄音專輯	live recording
debut album	首張專輯	first official album
concept album	概念專輯	unified theme/story
album track	專輯收錄曲	song on album
album cover	專輯封面	cover art
album release	專輯發行	official release
digital photo album	數碼相簿	digital photo collection
digital album	數碼專輯	digital music release

For your original sentence

> A gift that really stands out in my memory was a handmade photo **album** I gave to my mother for her birthday about two years ago.

Here:

album = 相簿；用來保存和展示照片的冊子

And because the next sentence says it contained:

- * printed photos,
- * captions,
- * notes,
- * tickets,
- * receipts,

it was really a **photo album with scrapbook features**.

A natural Traditional Chinese rendering is:

> 我記憶中最深刻的一份禮物，就是我大約兩年前在媽媽生日時送給她的一本手工**相簿**。

For this passage, **「相簿」** is the cleanest core translation, while **「剪貼簿式相簿」** describes the actual format more precisely.